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HISTORY · The Vedic Age: Early and Later Vedic society

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? After the Harappan cities faded, a new way of life grew in north India. Its people spoke an early form of Sanskrit and composed the **Vedas**. We call this the **Vedic Age** because our main source is the Vedic literature, not excavated cities. It has two parts: **Early Vedic (Rigvedic) about 1500–1000 BCE** (a tribal, cattle-herding society on the Sapta-Sindhu, the land of the seven rivers) and **Later Vedic about 1000–600 BCE** (settled farming kingdoms in the Ganga–Yamuna doab). Dates are approximate. **Why it matters:** the exam always asks the contrast between the two phases, and these ideas (varna, gotra, ashramas, kingship) shape later Indian history.

1. How do we know? The sources

Text	What it is	Facts to remember
Rigveda	Oldest Veda: hymns (suktas) in praise of gods	**10 mandalas, 1,028 hymns**. Mandalas 2–7 are the oldest 'family books'. Gayatri Mantra is in **Mandala 3** (to Savitri, by Vishvamitra). **Purusha Sukta** (origin of the four varnas) is in **Mandala 10**. Mandala 9: Soma.
Samaveda	Verses of the Rigveda set to music	Origin of Indian music
Yajurveda	Rules for performing sacrifices (yajna)	Prose and verse; Shukla and Krishna Yajurveda
Atharvaveda	Charms, spells, medicine, folk beliefs	Later; shows non-Aryan and everyday beliefs. The Mundaka Upanishad (with 'Satyameva Jayate') belongs to it.
Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads	Later texts: ritual explanation, forest teaching, philosophy	Source for **Later Vedic** period

The Vedas are called **Shruti** ('what is heard'): they were memorised and recited. **Archaeology:** the **Painted Grey Ware (PGW)** culture (about 1200–600 BCE) of the Ganga–Yamuna doab is linked with the Later Vedic people; sites include Hastinapur and Ahichchhatra.

2. Early Vedic (Rigvedic) society, c. 1500–1000 BCE

Place: the **Sapta-Sindhu** (land of seven rivers): the Indus, the five rivers of Punjab (**Jhelum–Vitasta, Chenab–Asikni, Ravi–Parushni, Beas–Vipasa, Sutlej–Shutudri**) and the **Sarasvati**, the most honoured river. The Ganga is hardly mentioned.

Aspect	Early Vedic

Politics	Tribal rule. The unit was **kula** (family) → **grama** (village) → **vis** (clan) → **jana** (tribe). Tribes: Bharata, Purus, Yadus, Turvasas, Anus, Druhyus. Head: **Rajan** (chief, hereditary but checked by the tribe). Officers: **Purohita** (priest-adviser: Vashishtha, Vishvamitra), **Senani** (army), **Gramani** (village head). **Sabha** (council of elders) and **Samiti** (general assembly of the tribe) and **Vidatha** (oldest assembly; women also attended). No regular army, no regular tax: people gave voluntary gifts (**bali**). The king did not own land. **Battle of the Ten Kings (Dasarajna)** on the Parushni (Ravi): **Sudas** of the Bharata tribe won.
Society	Patriarchal joint family (**kula**; father = **kulapa**). Women were respected: women poets such as **Apala, Ghosha, Lopamudra, Vishvavara**; they attended assemblies; no sati or child marriage. Three classes (**varna** = 'colour' or class) were mainly by work: Brahma (priests), Kshatriya (warriors), Vish/Vaishya (people); the fourth, Shudra, appears only in the late **Purusha Sukta**. Enemies were called **Dasa/Dasyu**.
Economy	**Pastoral**: cattle were the main wealth ('gopati', 'gavishti' = search for cows = war). Farming was secondary (barley = **yava**). **Horse and chariot** were central. Metal: copper/bronze (**ayas**). Craftsmen: carpenters, weavers, smiths, potters. Barter; **nishka** was a gold ornament. No cities.
Religion	Worship of **nature gods** through hymns and fire sacrifice; no temples or idols. **Indra** (rain/thunder, 'Purandara' = fort-breaker; about 250 hymns, most), **Agni** (fire, messenger to gods; about 200 hymns), **Varuna** (guardian of **Rita**, cosmic order), **Soma** (sacred plant/drink), **Surya, Ushas, Maruts, Ashvins**. Male gods dominate.

3. Later Vedic society, c. 1000–600 BCE

Why things changed: people moved east to the **Ganga–Yamuna doab** and started to clear forests with **iron tools** (iron, called **krishna/shyama ayas**, is known from about 1000 BCE). Farming became the main work, a surplus grew, and with it came kings, priests and a stricter class order.

Aspect	Later Vedic
Politics	Tribes merged into larger territories, **janapadas/rashtras**: **Kuru–Panchala** (capital Hastinapur, then Kaushambi), Kosala, Kashi, Videha. The king's power grew through rituals: **Rajasuya** (coronation), **Ashvamedha** (horse sacrifice to claim supremacy), **Vajapeya** (chariot race). Titles: Samrat, Ekrat, Rajadhiraja. Advisers called **Ratnins** ('jewel-holders'). Regular tax: **bali**, **bhaga**. Vidatha vanished; Sabha and Samiti remained but women were excluded.
Society	**Four varnas** became hereditary: Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra (lowest, no right to Vedic study). Priests and warriors were dominant. **Gotra** (clan from a common ancestor; marriage within the same gotra forbidden) appears. **Ashramas**: Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha (the fourth, Sannyasa, was not yet fixed). Women lost status; child marriage and dowry hints appear.
Economy	**Agriculture** became the main occupation: wheat, rice (**vrihi**), barley, pulses; iron ploughshare; **PGW** pottery. Crafts grew (metal-working, weaving, pottery, carpentry). Early towns (Hastinapur, Kaushambi) and trade increased; **nishka** and **satamana** were used as units of value.
Religion	**Indra and Agni lost importance**; **Prajapati** (creator), **Vishnu** (preserver) and **Rudra** (Shiva) rose. Sacrifices became long, costly and priest-controlled. The **Upanishads** questioned rituals and taught

	Atman–Brahman, karma, rebirth, moksha: the philosophy that Buddhism and Jainism soon challenged.

EXAMPLE

Example to remember the shift: in the Early Vedic period a chief's wealth = number of cows, and war was 'search for cows'. In the Later Vedic period a king's wealth = fertile land and tax, so he needed priests to perform the Ashvamedha to prove his supremacy over many villages.

EXAM TRAP

Gayatri Mantra: Rigveda **Mandala 3**. Purusha Sukta: **Mandala 10**. Oldest Veda: **Rigveda** (not Atharvaveda). Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha: **Early Vedic** (Vidatha disappears later). **Gotra, four ashramas (three fixed), rigid varna, Rajasuya/Ashvamedha, iron, PGW**: all **Later Vedic**. The king did **not** collect regular tax in the Early Vedic period. Indus (Sindhu) is the most mentioned river; Sarasvati the most sacred.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Rigveda:

1. It has ten mandalas.

2. The Gayatri Mantra is in the third mandala.

3. The Purusha Sukta is in the tenth mandala.

4. It is the latest of the four Vedas.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The Rigveda is the oldest Veda, so 4 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (deity) with List-II (what he/she stands for in the Rigveda):

List-I (deity)	List-II (what he/she stands for in the Rigveda)
A. Indra	**1.** Fire, messenger between humans and gods
B. Varuna	**2.** Rain and thunder; most hymns

C. Agni	**3.** Guardian of cosmic order (Rita)
D. Soma	**4.** Sacred plant and its drink

(1) A → 2 B → 3 C → 1 D → 4

(2) A → 3 B → 2 C → 1 D → 4

(3) A → 2 B → 1 C → 3 D → 4

(4) A → 2 B → 3 C → 4 D → 1

Answer: (1) Indra: rain and thunder; Varuna: Rita; Agni: fire-messenger; Soma: sacred plant.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about the Early Vedic period is NOT correct?

A. Cattle were the main form of wealth.

B. The Rajan collected regular taxes and owned all the land.

C. Sabha and Samiti were tribal assemblies.

D. Sudas of the Bharata tribe won the Battle of the Ten Kings.

Answer: B. The Early Vedic king received voluntary gifts (bali); regular tax and land control came later.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Agriculture expanded in the Ganga–Yamuna doab in the Later Vedic period.

Reason (R): Iron tools made it possible to clear dense forests and plough heavier soil.

Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. Iron (from about 1000 BCE) is the reason for the clearing of forests and expansion of farming.

PRACTICE

Which of the following developments distinguish the Later Vedic from the Early Vedic society?

1. A shift from cattle-rearing to settled agriculture

2. Rise of rituals such as Rajasuya and Ashvamedha

3. Rise of Prajapati, Vishnu and Rudra

4. Greater importance of Indra and Agni

Select the correct answer:

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. Indra and Agni lost importance in the Later Vedic period.

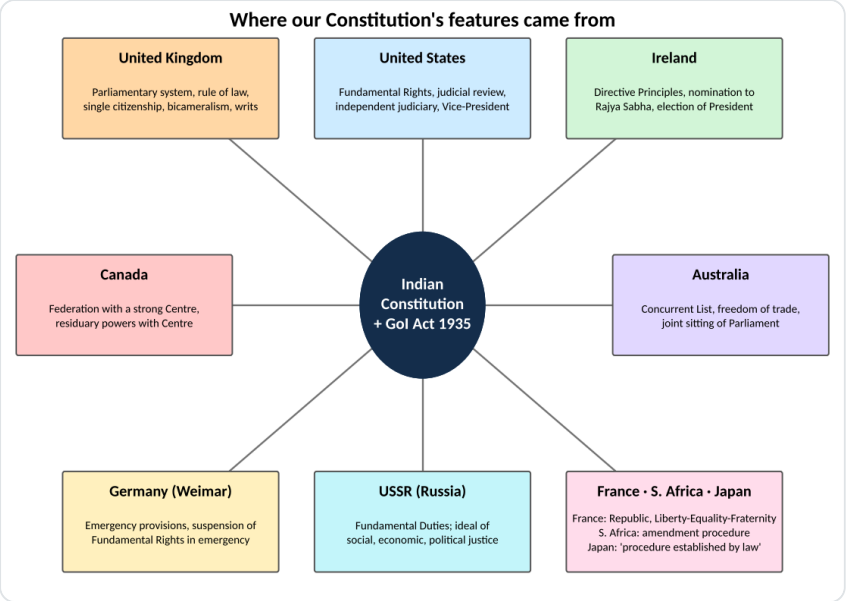
RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Draw a two-column table, Early vs Later Vedic, covering politics, society, economy and religion. 2. Explain in four lines why iron changed Vedic society. 3. Write the four Vedas with one feature each.

POLITY · Salient features of the Constitution

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Day 1 told you how the Constitution was made. Now we ask: what is special in it, and where did its ideas come from? The Constituent Assembly did not copy one country; it **borrowed the best working ideas** from many constitutions and **fitted them to Indian conditions**, mainly following the Government of India Act 1935 for the administrative details. Knowing the features and their sources is a certain exam question.



Sources of the Indian Constitution

1. The main features, with the idea behind each

Feature	What it means	Why / where it shows
Lengthiest written Constitution	Details of Centre, States, services, elections, emergency, all in one document (395 Articles originally; about 450 now).	Because India is big and diverse, nothing was left to convention.
Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic	Words of the Preamble: free from outside control; head of State is elected, not hereditary. (Socialist and Secular were added by the **42nd Amendment, 1976**.)	Studied fully on Day 3.
Parliamentary government	Real power lies with the Council of Ministers, answerable to the Lok Sabha; the President is the nominal head.	Taken from the UK; it gives close link between legislature and executive.
Federal with a unitary bias	Two levels of government but a strong Centre.	Union List/State List/Concurrent List; Centre's emergency powers, Governor appointed by the Centre.
Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles	Rights are enforceable in court; Directive Principles guide the State to build a welfare society (not enforceable).	Together they are called the 'conscience' of the Constitution.
Independent and integrated judiciary	One single pyramid: Supreme Court → High Courts → subordinate courts, which apply both Union and State laws (the USA has separate federal and State courts).	Judges' security of tenure; judicial review.
Single citizenship, universal adult franchise	One citizenship for all (no separate State citizenship). Every citizen aged **18+** can vote (lowered from 21 by the **61st Amendment 1988**).	A citizen of Andhra Pradesh who moves to Gujarat keeps the same citizenship and rights.

Emergency provisions	National (Art 352), State (Art 356) and Financial (Art 360) emergencies; the Centre becomes stronger.	From the Weimar Constitution of Germany.
Rigid and flexible	Amendment by **Art 368**: some parts by simple majority, most by special majority, and federal parts also need half of the States.	Procedure from South Africa.
Fundamental Duties, Three-tier government	Duties added by the **42nd Amendment (1976)** on the Swaran Singh Committee (10 duties; the 11th added by the **86th Amendment 2002**). **73rd and 74th Amendments (1992)** added Panchayats and Municipalities.	Duties idea from the USSR.

2. Sources: who gave what

Source	Features borrowed
Government of India Act 1935	Federal scheme, office of Governor, Federal Court (now Supreme Court), Public Service Commissions, emergency provisions (partly), administrative details
UK	Parliamentary system, rule of law, legislative procedure, single citizenship, Cabinet system, bicameralism, writs, Speaker
USA	Fundamental Rights, independence of judiciary and judicial review, Preamble, impeachment of the President, removal of Supreme Court and High Court judges, post of Vice-President
Ireland	Directive Principles of State Policy, nomination of members to the Rajya Sabha, method of electing the President
Canada	Federation with a strong Centre, residuary powers with the Centre, appointment of State Governors by the Centre, advisory jurisdiction of the Supreme Court
Australia	Concurrent List, freedom of trade and commerce, joint sitting of the two Houses
Germany (Weimar)	Emergency provisions; suspension of Fundamental Rights during emergency
USSR	Fundamental Duties; ideal of social, economic and political justice in the Preamble
France · South Africa · Japan	France: Republic and the ideals of Liberty, Equality, Fraternity. South Africa: amendment procedure and election of Rajya Sabha members. Japan: 'procedure established by law'

EXAM TRAP

Rights and judicial review: **USA**. DPSP and Rajya Sabha nominations: **Ireland**. Residuary powers with the Centre: **Canada** (the USA gives them to States). Concurrent List: **Australia**. Emergency: **Germany**. Fundamental Duties: **USSR**. Parliamentary system and writs: **UK**. India has an **integrated** (single) judiciary, not a dual one. India's citizenship is **single**, not dual. Fundamental Duties were **not** in the original Constitution.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the sources of the Indian Constitution:

1. The idea of Fundamental Duties was taken from the USSR.

2. Directive Principles of State Policy were taken from Ireland.

3. Emergency provisions were taken from the Weimar Constitution of Germany.

4. Judicial review was taken from the United Kingdom.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. Judicial review comes from the USA, not the UK.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (feature) with List-II (source):

List-I (feature)	List-II (source)
A. Concurrent List	1. USA
B. Residuary powers with the Centre	2. Canada
C. Fundamental Rights	3. Australia
D. Nomination of members to the Rajya Sabha	4. Ireland

(1) A → 3 B → 2 C → 1 D → 4

(2) A → 3 B → 1 C → 2 D → 4

(3) A → 2 B → 3 C → 1 D → 4

(4) A → 3 B → 2 C → 4 D → 1

Answer: (1) Concurrent List: Australia; residuary powers: Canada; Fundamental Rights: USA; Rajya Sabha nominations: Ireland.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct about the Indian Constitution?

A. It provides for single citizenship for the whole country.

B. It has a dual judiciary with separate federal and State courts, like the USA.

C. It provides for universal adult franchise.

D. It provides for a bicameral Parliament at the Centre.

Answer: B. India has an integrated judiciary: a single pyramid of courts.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Indian Constitution is both rigid and flexible.
Reason (R): Some provisions can be amended by a simple majority of Parliament, while others need a special majority and ratification by half of the States.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. The three-way amendment procedure of Art 368 makes it a mix of flexible and rigid.

PRACTICE

A woman born in Andhra Pradesh shifts to Gujarat for work. She does not need to acquire any separate 'Gujarat citizenship' and enjoys the same citizenship rights. Which feature of the Constitution does this illustrate?

A. Single citizenship

B. Dual citizenship

C. Federal citizenship

D. Domicile-based citizenship

Answer: A. India has only one citizenship for the whole country (borrowed from the UK).

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Draw the 'sources' picture from memory: write each country with its features. 2. Why is the judiciary called 'integrated'? 3. Which features make the Constitution federal and which make it unitary? Give three each.

REASONING · Letter series and odd man out

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Letter series is the number series of Day 1, but with letters. The trick: **turn each letter into its position number (A = 1 to Z = 26)**, find the rule on the numbers, then turn back to letters. An **odd man out** question gives a group of items; all but one share a hidden property, and you must find the one that does not. Both appear every year.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

EXAMPLE

Memory tools: (1) **EJOTY** = positions 5, 10, 15, 20, 25 (multiples of 5). (2) **Opposite letters:** the letter's position from the left + position from the right = **27** (A–Z, B–Y, C–X, M–N). (3) Halfway: **M = 13, N = 14**.

1. Common letter-series patterns

Pattern	Example	Answer and why
Constant skip	B, E, H, K, N, ?	**Q**: positions 2, 5, 8, 11, 14, so +3 → 17 = Q
Growing skip	A, C, F, J, O, ?	**U**: 1, 3, 6, 10, 15; gaps +2, +3, +4, +5, next +6 → 21 = U
Backward series	Z, X, U, Q, L, ?	**F**: 26, 24, 21, 17, 12; gaps −2, −3, −4, −5, next −6 → 6 = F
Pairs (front up, back down)	AZ, BY, CX, DW, ?	**EV**: first letter +1, second letter −1
Alternate two series	A, Z, C, X, E, V, ?	**G**: odd places A, C, E, G (+2); even places Z, X, V (−2)

2. Odd man out: how to attack

- **Letter groups:** write positions, look at the gaps inside each group. Example: KMO (+2, +2), GIK (+2, +2), PRT (+2, +2), TVW (+2, +1): **TVW** is odd.
- **Pairs:** check the sum or the difference of positions. Example: AZ (1+26 = 27), EV (5+22 = 27), IR (9+18 = 27), MN (13+14 = 27), QL (17+12 = 29): **QL** is odd.

- **Numbers:** look for squares, cubes, primes, multiples. Example: 8, 27, 64, 100, 125 → all cubes except **100**.
- **Words:** look for category (animals, cities, rivers), but the exam often hides a second rule such as number of letters.

EXAM TRAP

Always check **both** the gaps and the direction (forward/backward). Do not stop at the first rule that fits two terms; it must fit **all** terms. In pairs, test the sum 27 first.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Find the next letter: A, C, F, J, O, ?

A. S

B. T

C. U

D. V

Answer: C. Positions 1, 3, 6, 10, 15; the gaps grow 2, 3, 4, 5, so the next gap is 6 and 15 + 6 = 21 = U.

PRACTICE

Find the next letter: Z, X, U, Q, L, ?

A. E

B. F

C. G

D. H

Answer: B. Positions 26, 24, 21, 17, 12; the gaps are −2, −3, −4, −5, so the next gap is −6 and 12 − 6 = 6 = F.

PRACTICE

Find the next term: AZ, BY, CX, DW, ?

A. EV

B. EU

C. FV

D. EW

Answer: A. The first letter moves forward by 1 and the second letter backward by 1: E and V.

PRACTICE

Which pair is the odd one out? AZ, EV, IR, MN, QL

A. EV

B. IR

C. MN

D. QL

Answer: D. In AZ, EV, IR, MN the positions add up to 27; in QL they add up to 29.

PRACTICE

Which group is the odd one out? KMO, GIK, PRT, DFH, TVW

A. GIK

B. PRT

C. DFH

D. TVW

Answer: D. All others move +2, +2 within the group; TVW moves +2, +1.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the memory tools (EJOTY and the sum 27) in your own words. 2. Solve: B, D, G, K, ? and make up your own letter series. 3. List the four things to check in odd man out.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 2: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: Vedic Age, Politics · Society · Economy · Religion

	Early Vedic 1500–1000 BCE	Later Vedic 1000–600 BCE
Place	Sapta-Sindhu	Ganga–Yamuna doab
Politics	Jana, Rajan, Purohita, Senani, Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha; bali; Dasarajna (Sudas)	Janapadas (Kuru–Panchala); Rajasuya, Ashvamedha, Vajapeya; Ratnins; regular tax
Society	Patriarchal family; women poets (Apala, Ghosha, Lopamudra); 3 varnas by work	4 hereditary varnas; gotra; ashramas; women's status falls
Economy	Cattle, barley, horse and chariot, copper; barter, nishka	Iron, farming (wheat, rice), PGW, early towns, satamana
Religion	Indra, Agni, Varuna, Soma; hymns and fire sacrifice; no temples	Prajapati, Vishnu, Rudra; costly rituals; Upanishads (Atman–Brahman, karma, moksha)

Also write: 4 Vedas with one line each; Gayatri = Mandala 3, Purusha Sukta = Mandala 10; PGW c. 1200–600 BCE. Hook: Early = cows, Later = crops, iron caused the change.

POLITY: Salient features and sources

- 10 features in one line each: longest written; Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic (42nd Amend 1976); parliamentary; federal with unitary bias; FR + DPSP; integrated judiciary; single citizenship, vote at 18 (61st Amend 1988); emergency; rigid and flexible (Art 368); duties (42nd; 11th by 86th Amend 2002) and 3 tiers (73rd, 74th).
- Hub drawing: UK (parliament, writs), USA (rights, judicial review), Ireland (DPSP, Rajya Sabha nominations), Canada (strong Centre, residuary), Australia (Concurrent List), Germany (emergency), USSR (duties), France/S. Africa/Japan, plus 1935 Act.

REASONING: Letter series and odd man out

Write A=1 … Z=26, EJOTY = 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, opposite letters sum to 27. Five patterns with one example each: constant skip, growing skip, backward, pairs, alternate series. Odd man out: check gaps, sum 27, squares/cubes, word category.